JACOB R. SMITH

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (Expected May 2027)
Advisor: Daniel J. Smith

M.A. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (2025)

B.S. Mathematical Economics & Philosophy, *magna cum laude*, Hampden-Sydney College (2023)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Choice Theory, Austrian Economics, Political Economy of Regulation, Historical Political Economy

WORKING PAPERS

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic Capture of the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897" (job market paper)

Newly digitized state-by-year Internal Revenue panel (FY1887–1908, 32 states); event-study and difference-in-differences estimates show the Act did not foreclose rectified whiskey — the straight–rectified gap narrowed about 23 percent — but created a certified premium tier whose rents (91 percent of bonded withdrawals) went to incumbent Kentucky and Pennsylvania distillers.

"Private Mechanisms for Stopping Diamond-Dybvig Runs: Evidence from U.S. Newspapers, 1889–1929" (with Daniel J. Smith)

Novel dataset of 544 bank runs from digitized newspapers; codes 40 distinct private mitigation mechanisms, eight not previously documented; 70 percent of runs with a reported response used more than one mechanism.

"Who Killed the Green Fairy? Temperance, Language, and Wine in the Swiss Absinthe Ban of 1908" (with Nicholas A. Jensen)

Canton-level records of the 1906–07 petition and the 1908 vote: organized temperance (Protestant share) predicts petition signatures; holding the French-speaking share fixed, a one-point higher share of national wine revenue goes with a 0.62-point higher yes-share, with no wine effect on six unrelated federal ballots.

"Uncorked: How Wall Street Priced the Repeal of Prohibition" (with Patricia Hummel and Corey Pendleton)

Event study of alcohol and related-industry stocks around newspaper-dated repeal events, 1933 (CAPM, Fama–French, Carhart): alcohol stocks rose when New York voted for repeal delegates, then fell sharply once Alabama, Arkansas, and Tennessee made repeal certain, consistent with investors expecting competition to erode Prohibition-era profits.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Crisis and Local Leviathan"

"Alms and Ale: A Malthusian Test of Welfare Generosity and Alcohol Consumption in OECD Countries, 1995–2023"

OTHER WRITING

"When 'Consumer Protection' Protects Producers from Competition," *The Daily Economy* (AIER), August 11, 2026

ACADEMIC CONFERENCE PAPER PRESENTATIONS

"Bottled in Bondage", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Fort Lauderdale, Florida, November 19–21, 2022

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic use of the Bottled-In-Bond Act of 1897 by both firms and regulators", *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Plano, Texas, March 14–16, 2024

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic use of the Bottled-In-Bond Act of 1897 by both firms and regulators", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Washington, DC, November 23–25, 2024

"The Father of Food and Drug Law as Strategic Regulator: Dr. Harvey Wiley and the Bottled-In-Bond Act", *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Louisville, Kentucky, March 6–8, 2025

"Panic Before Protection: Bank Runs, Contagion, and Mitigation Measures in the United States, 1889–1929", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Tampa, Florida, November 22–24, 2025

"Alms and Ale: A Malthusian Test of Welfare Generosity and Alcohol Consumption", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Tampa, Florida, November 22–24, 2025

COLLOQUIA & WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

Public Choice Outreach Conference, *Center for Study of Public Choice*, GMU (2023)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Public Choice, *American Institute for Economic Research* (2024)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Defending Classical Liberalism, *AIER* (2025)

Summer Seminars on Classical Liberalism, *AIER*, UIC, UIS, and Wabash College (2025)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium, *Bridwell Institute*, SMU Cox (2025)

Law & Economics w/ PC Insights Workshop, *Stephenson Institute for Classical Liberalism* (2025)

The Untold Stories Behind Financial Crises Workshop, *INET-YSI-University of Lyon 2* (2025)

"Giving an Effective Job Talk" Graduate Papers Workshop, *Institute for Humane Studies* (2026)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Governance and Self-Governance: Vincent Ostrom's Framework, *AIER* (2026)

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

American Institute for Economic Research Graduate Fellowship (Summer 2026)

Political Economy Research Institute Ph.D. Summer Fellowship, $5,000 (2024, 2025, 2026)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium Honorarium, *Bridwell Institute*, $3,000 (2025)

Center for the Study of Political Economy Fellowship (2019–2023)

Pi Mu Epsilon, US Honorary Mathematics Society (2022)

Beta Gamma Sigma, International Business Honor Society (2026)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee, *Virginia Economic Journal* (2026)

Moderator, panel on Tennessee whiskey regulation, MTSU Special Collections (scheduled April 2027)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Middle Tennessee State University

Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2026) — in progress

Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2025) — instructor evaluation mean 4.40/5

Principles of Macroeconomics (Spring 2026) — instructor evaluation mean 4.02/5

Prepared to teach, with adequate preparation time, any undergraduate course in the curriculum; trained for intermediate microeconomics, econometrics, machine learning for economics, money and banking, public economics and public choice, and economic history.

SOFTWARE

Stata, R, LaTeX; Python (working knowledge)

EXPERIENCE

Defense Logistics Agency – Aviation, Richmond, VA May 2021 – Current

Post-Award Contract Specialist (Trainee)

- Federal contract administration under the FAR/DFARS; resolved contract discrepancies with OEM vendors and subject-matter experts

REFERENCES

Daniel J. Smith (advisor) — Professor of Economics and Director, Political Economy Research Institute, Middle Tennessee State University · daniel.smith@mtsu.edu

Adam Rennhoff — Professor of Economics and Director of Graduate Programs in Economics, Middle Tennessee State University · adam.rennhoff@mtsu.edu

Ryan M. Yonk — Director of Education and Senior Research Fellow, American Institute for Economic Research · ryan.yonk@aier.org